

COVER STORY: BEIJING 2008

HOW CHINA BECAME A SUPERPOWER 66

The drive for constant improvement is what sporting success is built on. With an Olympics to host, the Chinese state put its weight and focus behind it. The rest is golden history.



NATION: THIRD FRONT

The Third Affront

19

Too many prime ministerial candidates, clashing egos, ideological dissonance and disagreements over seat-sharing arrangements render the much touted alternative alliance a non-starter.

STATES: BIHAR



KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

Rage of the River 22

With the Kosi river changing its course, 25 lakh people are rendered homeless in the state. The crisis may aggravate in the coming weeks as the river continues to swell.

NEIGHBOURS: PAKISTAN

Advantage Zardari 30

After having Pervez Musharraf ousted, Asif Zardari stakes his claim to the presidency. But with the coalition splitting, political uncertainty heightens.



AFP PHOTO/FAROOQ NAEEM



SIPRA DAS

HEALTH: SURGERY

Cutting Edge

82

With technology taking away much of the blood-and-gut messiness of surgery, modern ORs get closer to the world of *Star Trek*. For the patient this means a speedy recovery and a heavy bill.

B-SCHOOL SPECIAL: SURVEY Best B-schools 36



The toppers, what students now expect, why entrance examinations need to change and what the future holds for the MBA. Here's an in-depth report.

OFFTRACK.....	12
INDIASCOPE.....	14
BUSINESS AND ECONOMY.....	34
SOCIETY AND THE ARTS.....	88
YOUR WEEK.....	99
EYECATCHERS.....	106

Turn to pg.
Jobs Today 104

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job offers in the Market.

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